Hostinger marketing attribution: which channels and creators bring profitable customers?

OVERVIEW

Independent case study for Hostinger's Marketing Data Analyst role: five questions for the Affiliates, Influencers, PPC, SEO and Product Marketing teams, worked end to end with SQL (DuckDB), Python and Power BI on SIMULATED data calibrated on hostinger.com.

SIMULATED · PAGES 2-3

17% → 8%

of sales credited to coupon sites by last click vs data-driven attribution; 56% of their buyers already had a cart

SIMULATED · PAGE 3

+37%

more creator sales than links and codes show (brand searches after videos); 4,226 code uses came from leaks

SIMULATED · PAGE 4

€104 vs €76

net value of an SEO customer vs a PPC non-brand customer after 24 months (refunds and renewals included)

SIMULATED · PAGE 5

14%

of brand-ad clicks are incremental: 86% come back through the organic result when ads are off (geo test)

Business questions

1 · Efficiency What does a customer cost per channel, and which channel pays back?
2 · Attribution What changes when the attribution model changes?
3 · Partners Which creators and affiliates are really worth their price?
4 · Quality Do the customers of each channel stay and renew?
5 · Budget Does spend create sales, and where should the next euro go?

Recommendation: steer budget on 12-month net value and incrementality, not last-click orders. Trim PPC non-brand by 20%, stop paying coupon commission when the cart was already started, and move the €305k to creators (+2,144 orders a year at the same budget). Keep 'hostinger' search ads only where competitors bid on the brand.

Data & methods

SIMULATED 30 months, 6 countries, 1.3M visitors, 2.6M touchpoints, 129,431 orders, generated in Python (seed 42). Not Hostinger data.
PUBLIC Hostinger prices and renewal prices, 30-day money-back guarantee, affiliate terms (hostinger.com, 10 Nov 2026).
SQL paths, 5 rule-based models (window functions), censoring-safe customer value, scorecards, data-quality checks.
Python Markov removal effect, geo-test difference-in-differences with bootstrap, video event study, response curves.
Power BI star schema, 41 DAX measures, an attribution-model switch on the efficiency page.
AI I used Claude Code to write the scripts efficiently. The decisions are mine: the questions, the data design and assumptions, the methods, the checks and the report build.

Hostinger context public facts used to calibrate the simulation, hostinger.com
Customers 5M+ in 150+ countries. **Plans** paid upfront; Premium $1.99/mo for 48 months, renews at $10.99/mo; VPS and Cloud the same way. **Refunds** 30-day money-back guarantee. **Affiliates** from 40% commission, 30-day cookie, none on 1-month plans or renewals.

How to read
Titles state the conclusion of the page. **Tag** SIMULATED marks generated data. **Dashed lines** mark break-even or a threshold. **Code** SQL, notebook and Power BI project in the repository.

Half the budget goes to PPC non-brand, which returns €0.60 per euro within 12 months

SIMULATED DATA

Under data-driven attribution PPC non-brand takes 51% of spend at €109 per order and does not pay back within a year; SEO returns €4.2. Value = first payment net of refunds (Hostinger's 30-day guarantee) plus renewals, expected at 12 months. Change the attribution model (top right) to see how the ranking moves.

Marketing spend, 30 months
€5M

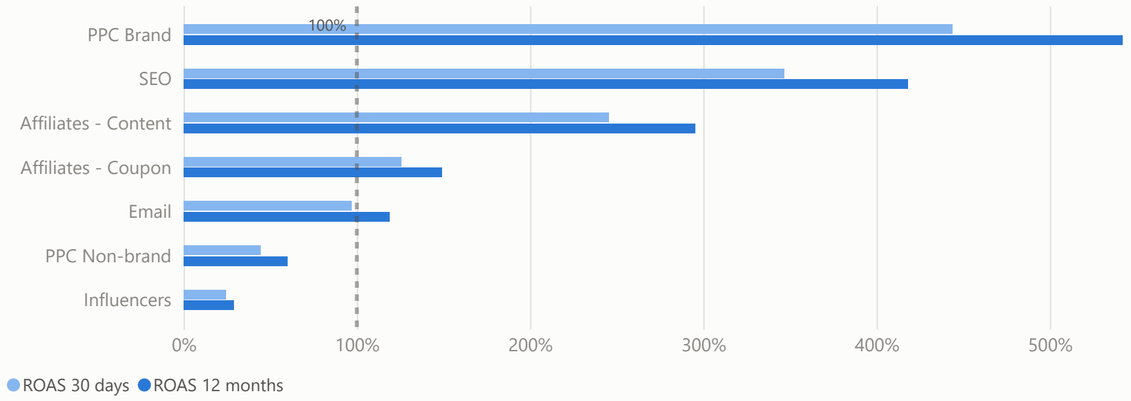
Orders
129K

Blended cost per order
€39

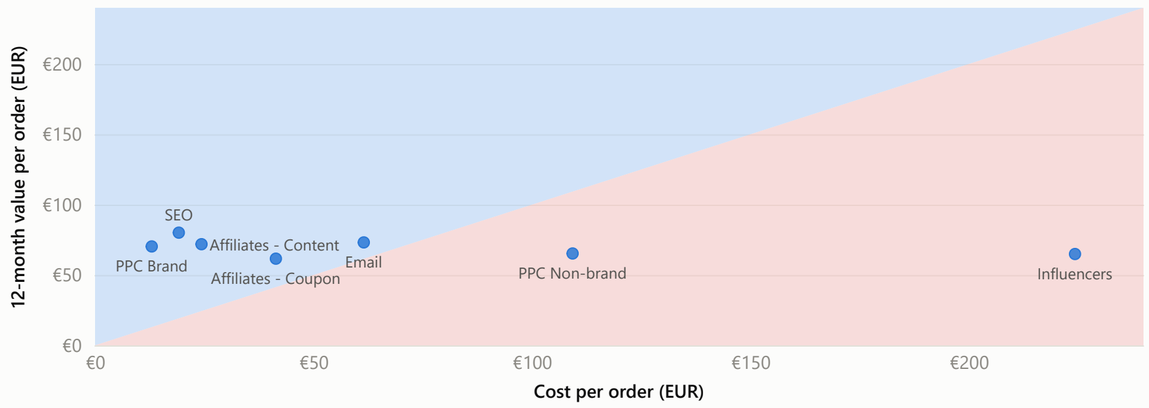
Blended 12-month ROAS
185%

Attribution model
Markov (data-driven)

ROAS by channel at 30 days and 12 months (dashed = break-even)



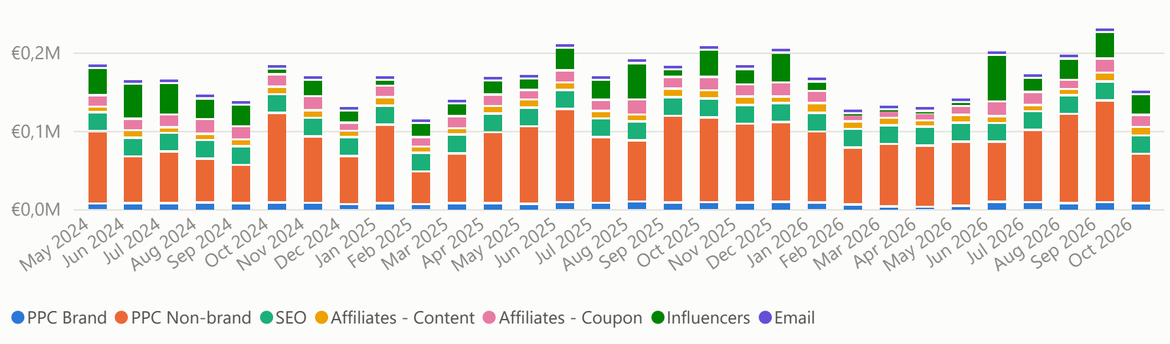
Cost per order vs 12-month value per order, EUR (red = costs more than it brings in)



Channel scorecard under the selected model (red = below break-even)

Channel	Spend	Spend Share	Orders	CAC	Value / order 12m	ROAS 12m
PPC Non-brand	€2 557 748	51%	23 398	€109	€65	60%
SEO	€720 003	14%	37 551	€19	€80	418%
Influencers	€684 348	14%	3 051	€224	€65	29%
Affiliates - Coupon	€444 803	9%	10 745	€41	€62	149%
Affiliates - Content	€278 100	6%	11 412	€24	€72	295%
PPC Brand	€183 272	4%	14 122	€13	€70	542%
Email	€179 996	4%	2 926	€62	€73	119%

Spend by month and channel, EUR (affiliate and CPA creator fees follow sales)

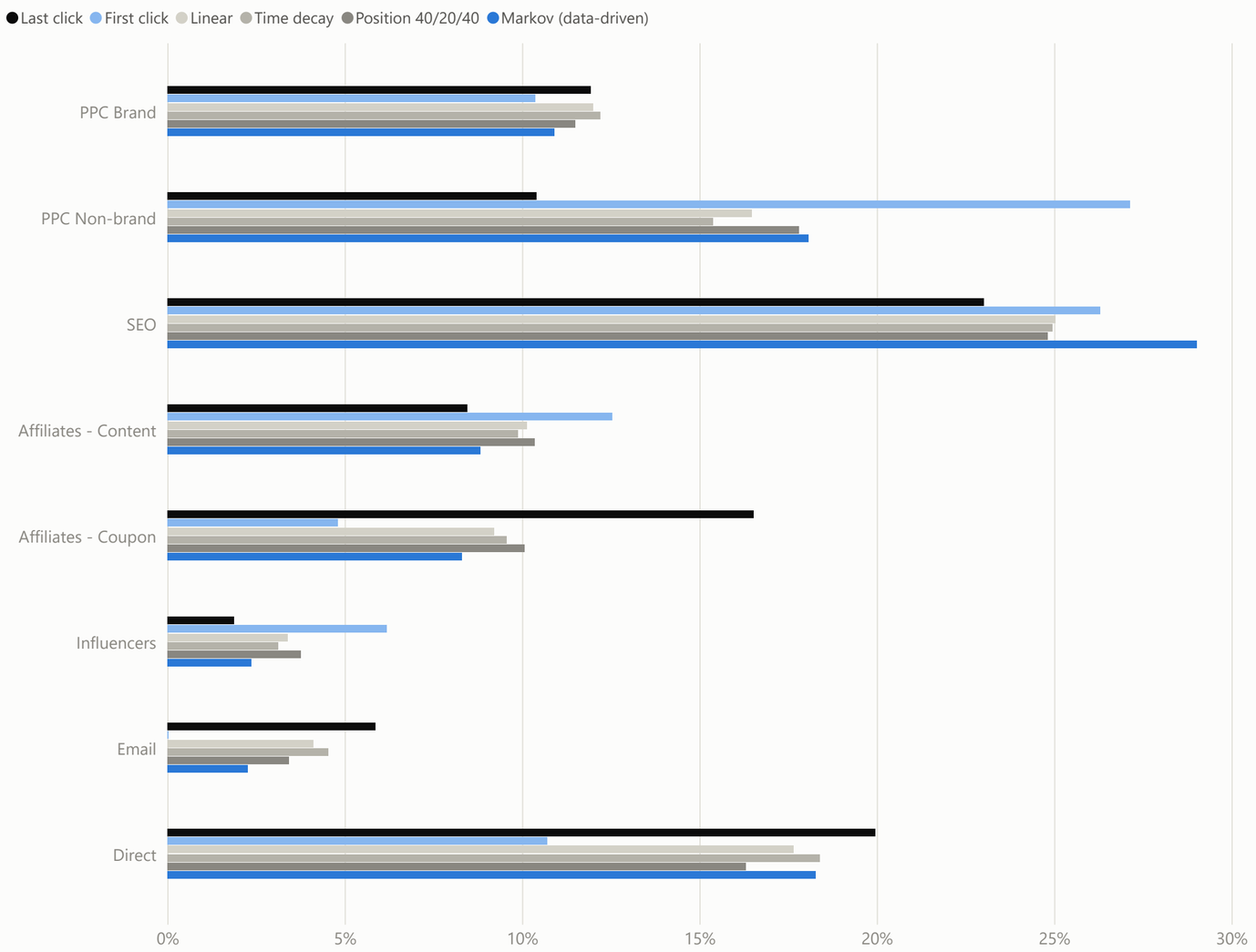


Last click gives coupon sites 17% of sales; data-driven attribution halves it

SIMULATED DATA

Same 129,431 orders, six ways to split the credit. Coupon sites and direct visits sit at the end of journeys, so last click flatters them; PPC non-brand and SEO start journeys. No click model sees a video that was watched but not clicked: influencers get 2-6% of credit under every model (page 3 measures them another way).

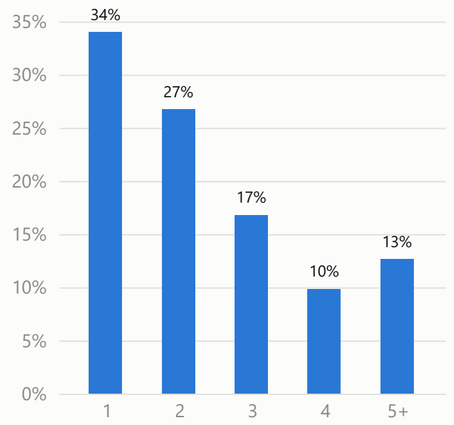
Share of orders credited to each channel, by attribution model



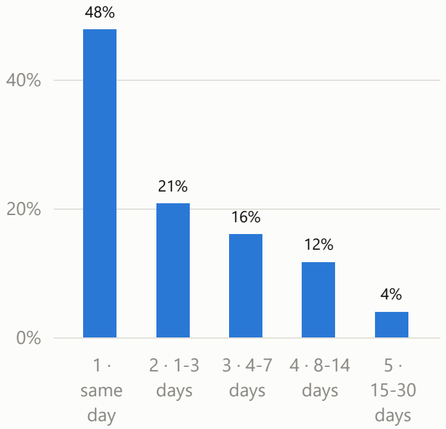
Most frequent conversion paths (30-day window, repeats collapsed)

#	Path	Orders	Share	Days to buy
1	SEO	14 849	11,7%	0,7
2	PPC Non-brand	12 703	10,0%	0,1
3	Affiliates - Content	6 270	4,9%	0,2
4	Direct	5 922	4,7%	0,8
5	PPC Brand	4 829	3,8%	0,4
6	SEO > Direct	3 671	2,9%	3,6
7	Affiliates - Coupon	2 616	2,1%	0,2
8	PPC Non-brand > Direct	2 572	2,0%	3,0
9	Influencers	2 421	1,9%	0,0
10	PPC Non-brand > SEO	2 324	1,8%	3,1
11	SEO > Affiliates - Coupon	2 315	1,8%	1,3
12	PPC Non-brand > Affiliates - Coupon	1 936	1,5%	0,8

Touchpoints before buying (share of orders)



Time from first touch to purchase



SIMULATED data (seed 42), calibrated on public hostinger.com prices, refund and affiliate terms (data/SOURCES.md) - not Hostinger data · Markov = removal effect on 1.3M journeys (buyers and non-buyers) · Independent case study for Hostinger's Marketing Data Analyst role · Not affiliated with Hostinger, no Hostinger data

Creators drive 37% more sales than links and codes show, but 3 leaked codes inflate their numbers

SIMULATED DATA

Brand searches rise 43% in the 2 weeks after a video. 4,226 creator-code orders (24%) came through coupon sites with no recent video: leaked codes, paid twice (Hostinger's 40%+ affiliate commission + creator fee). On coupon sites, 56% of buyers had already started a cart.

Creator fees, 30 months

€684K

Orders by link or genuine code

15K

Code orders from leaks

4 226

Coupon-site buyers with a cart already started

56%

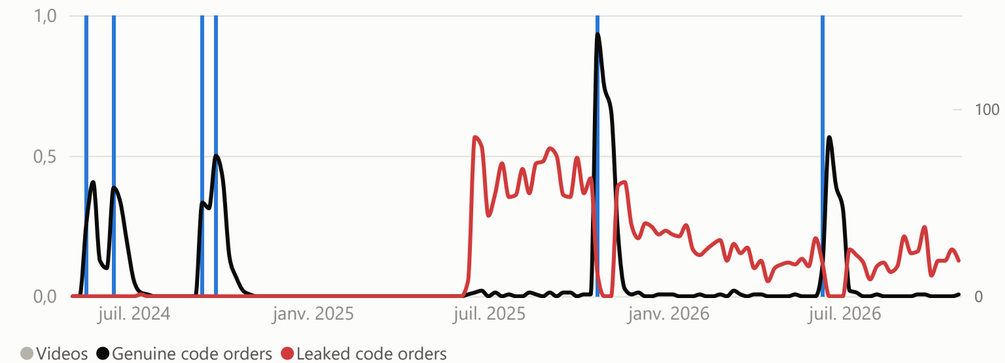
Creator scorecard (red = leaked codes / negative 12-month ROI)

Creator	Platform	Fee	Videos	Cost	Link orders	Code orders	Leaked	Refunds	Cost / genuine order	ROI 12m
CR17	YouTube	flat	9	€47 070	201	1 161	1%	9,8%	€38	21%
CR02	YouTube	flat	6	€44 340	149	3 574	67%	11,1%	€35	40%
CR33	YouTube	flat	7	€40 880	88	521	0%	9,4%	€73	-31%
CR07	TikTok	flat	5	€39 450	38	231	2%	7,8%	€164	-53%
CR23	Instagram	flat	7	€36 470	51	275	1%	9,4%	€121	-38%
CR09	YouTube	flat	7	€33 880	82	434	0%	11,7%	€72	0%
CR11	YouTube	hybrid	3	€32 424	151	1 915	59%	10,1%	€38	100%
CR21	TikTok	flat	8	€31 040	89	480	1%	8,7%	€59	-15%
CR18	YouTube	CPA	5	€29 525	92	1 141	55%	10,6%	€53	-12%
CR08	TikTok	flat	4	€28 600	45	311	1%	11,0%	€89	-21%
CR29	YouTube	flat	9	€26 100	61	288	0%	7,4%	€82	6%
CR26	YouTube	flat	7	€22 750	31	199	1%	10,1%	€107	-35%

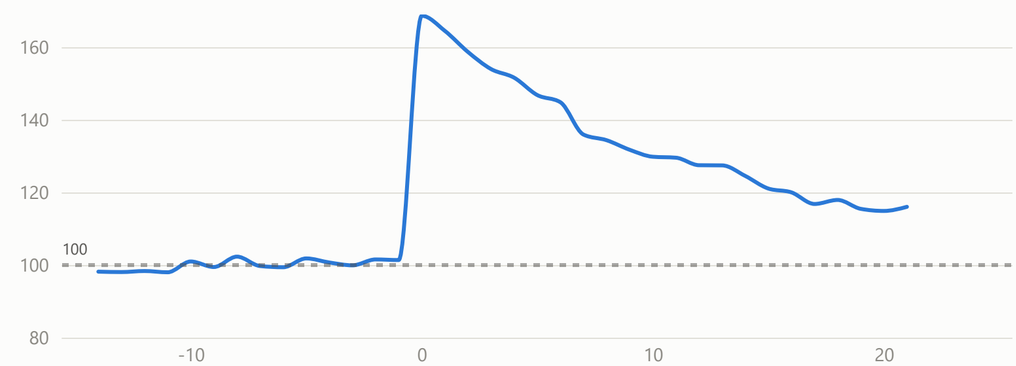
Affiliates by type (orders where the affiliate is the last click = what commission is paid on)

Type	Orders	Commission	Refunds	Cart already started
coupon	21 394	€444 803	12,0%	56%
content	7 671	€190 822	6,7%	0%
review	3 257	€87 277	6,1%	0%

CR02: weekly genuine code uses (black) and leaked uses (red); columns = videos published



Brand searches around a sponsored video, in the creator's country (100 = 2 weeks before; day 0 = video)



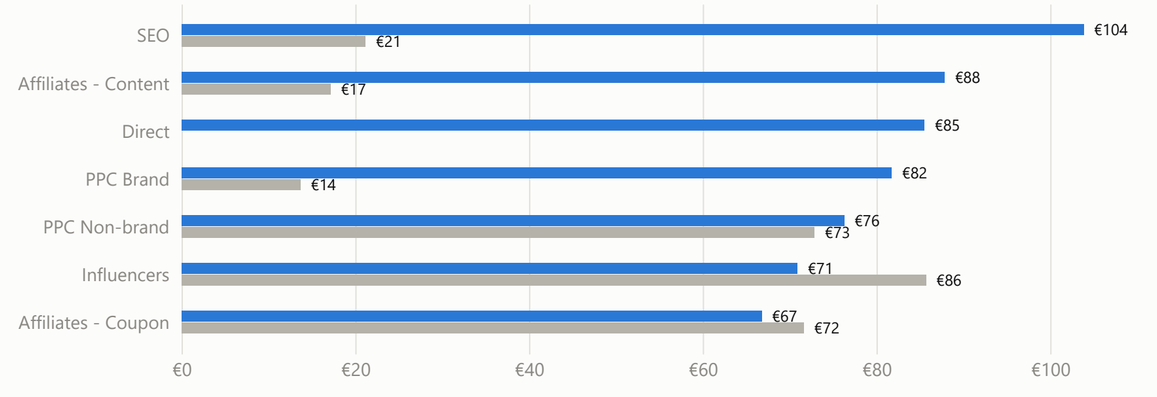
SIMULATED data (seed 42), calibrated on public hostinger.com prices, refund and affiliate terms (data/SOURCES.md) - not Hostinger data · Leak = creator code used after a coupon-site click with no video in the previous 21 days · Independent case study for Hostinger's Marketing Data Analyst role · Not affiliated with Hostinger, no Hostinger data

An SEO customer is worth €104 after 24 months, a PPC non-brand customer €76

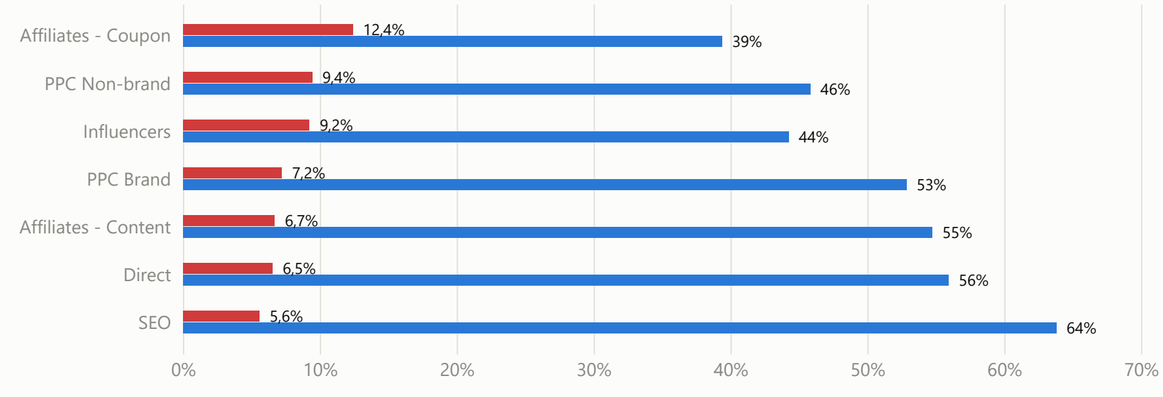
SIMULATED DATA

Hostinger plans are prepaid at an intro price and renew higher, with a 30-day money-back guarantee, so refunds, plan length and renewals drive value. PPC non-brand buyers refund 9% and choose a 1-month plan 18% of the time; SEO buyers refund 6% and renew 64%. By first-click channel; a cohort counts at month k only once k months have passed.

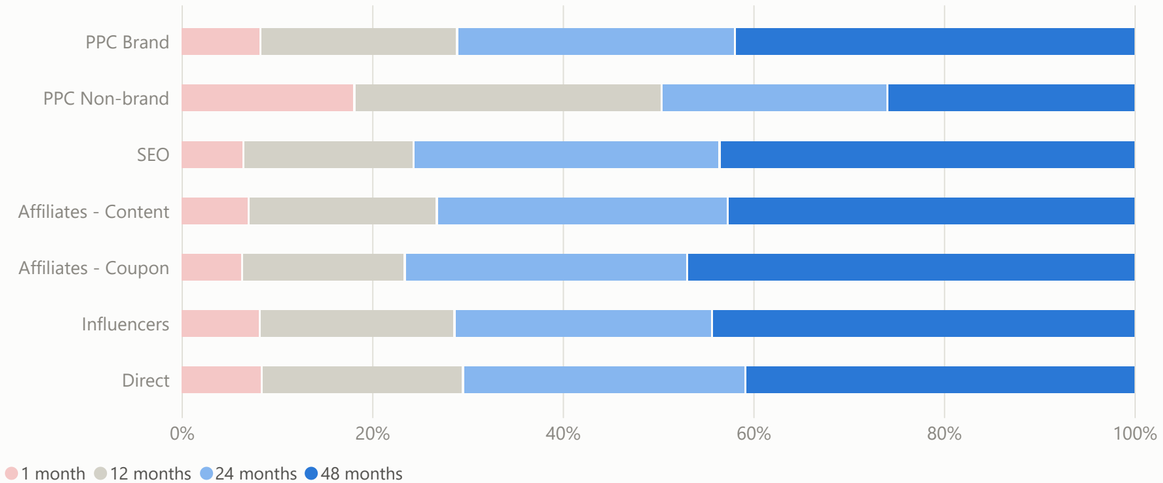
24-month net value per customer (blue) vs acquisition cost (grey), EUR



Refunded within 30 days (red) and renewed at the end of the term (blue)



Plan length chosen at purchase (1 / 12 / 24 / 48 months)



Cumulative net value per customer, EUR, by months since purchase

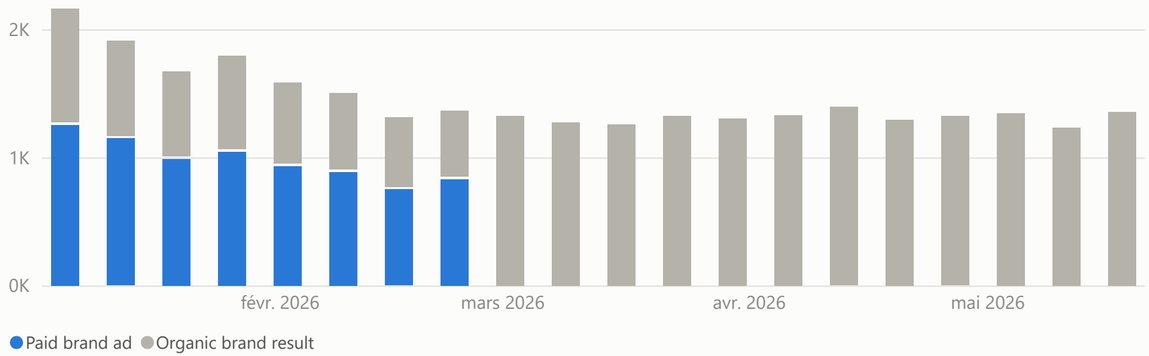
Channel	0	3	6	9	12	15	18	21	24
Affiliates - Content	€60	€61	€61	€61	€72	€72	€71	€71	€88
Affiliates - Coupon	€54	€55	€55	€55	€61	€61	€61	€58	€67
Direct	€59	€60	€60	€60	€71	€71	€70	€70	€85
Influencers	€53	€55	€54	€55	€63	€62	€62	€62	€71
PPC Brand	€57	€59	€59	€59	€70	€70	€70	€69	€82
PPC Non-brand	€48	€50	€51	€51	€66	€65	€65	€66	€76
SEO	€71	€72	€72	€73	€85	€85	€85	€85	€104

Brand ads are only 14% incremental; moving €305k to creators adds +2,144 orders a year

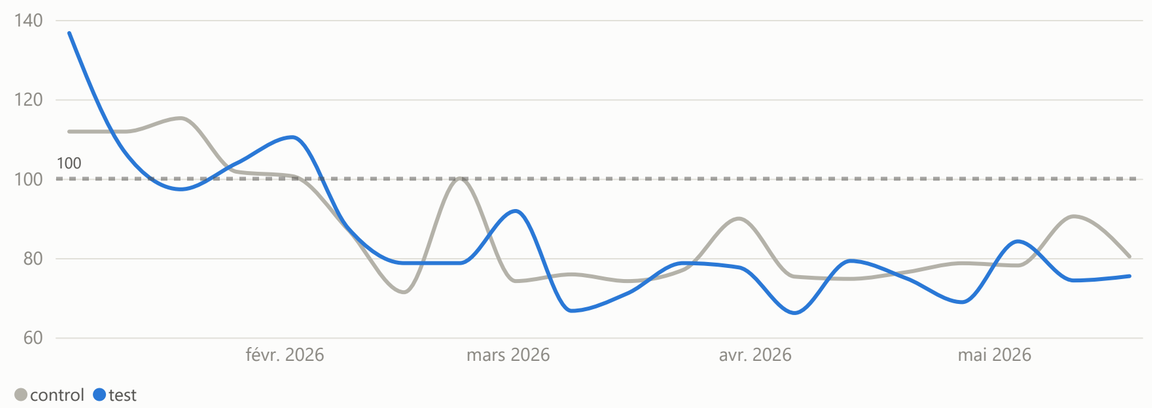
SIMULATED DATA

Geo test: search ads on 'hostinger' paused for 12 weeks in US, ES and ID. 86% of ad clicks came back through the organic brand result (95% CI 77%-95%). At the margin a PPC non-brand order costs €165, a creator order €67.

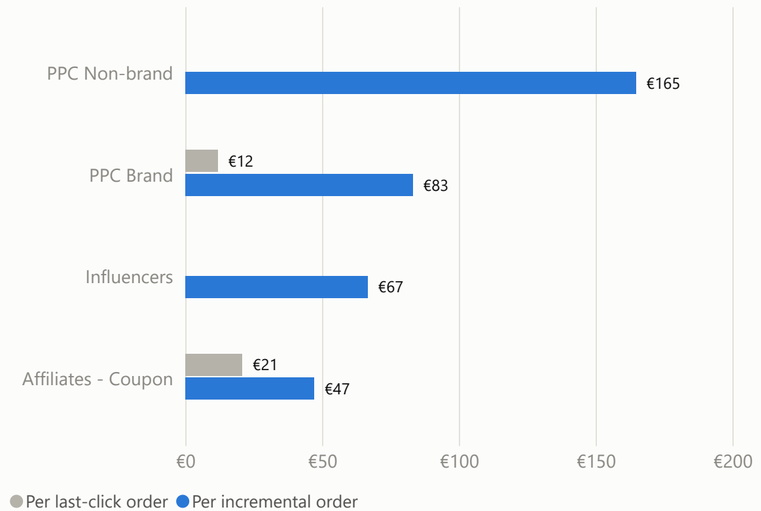
Test countries: weekly brand-search clicks, paid ad (blue) vs organic result (grey). Ads off from 2 March



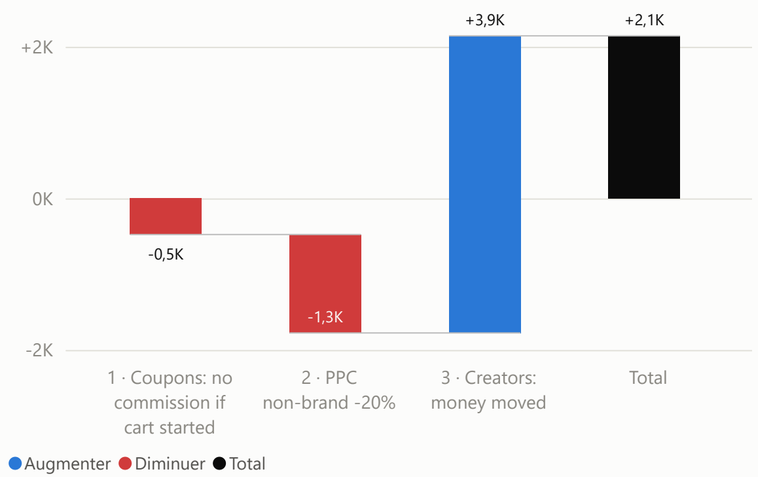
Brand-search orders, index 100 = 8 weeks before the test: test (blue) vs control (grey)



Cost per order as reported (grey) vs per incremental order (blue), EUR



Same budget, €305k moved: incremental orders over 12 months



Recommendations

1 · Budget on 12-month net value, not last-click orders: trim PPC non-brand by 20% and fund creators.
2 · Coupon sites: no commission when the cart was already started; one code per creator, revoked when it leaks.
3 · Brand ads: keep them only where competitors bid on the brand name.

Next quarter's test plan

Geo holdout on creators (2 countries, 8 weeks) to replace the halo estimate with a measured lift; brand-ad test by country with competitor-bid monitoring; refund-rate alert per partner.

SIMULATED data (seed 42), calibrated on public hostinger.com prices, refund and affiliate terms (data/SOURCES.md) - not Hostinger data · DiD = difference-in-differences, bootstrap 5,000 resamples of weeks · Independent case study for Hostinger's Marketing Data Analyst role · Not affiliated with Hostinger, no Hostinger data